

Zihao Ma

PH.D. STUDENT · DATABASE SYSTEMS

School of Computer Science and Technology, Xidian University · Xi'an, China

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Education

Xidian University

PH.D. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

Xi'an, China

Sep. 2023 – Jun. 2028 (Expected)

- Joint Ph.D. Program with Qiyuan Laboratory (2024 cohort); transferred from the M.S. program in 2024.
- **Weighted Average:** 91.69/100 **Degree-Course Average:** 90.15/100 **Major Rank:** 63
- Five courses with grades of 90/100 or above.

Xidian University

B.ENG. IN SOFTWARE ENGINEERING (SPECIALIZATION: EMBEDDED SYSTEM)

Xi'an, China

Aug. 2019 – Jun. 2023

- **Course Score:** 88.9/100 **GPA:** 3.8/4.0 **Rank:** 4/53 (Top 8%) **First-Prize Scholarship, 2022**
- **A Courses:** Computer Organization and Architecture, Compiler Principles, Database Systems, and 39 others

Publications

Towards Selecting Informative Alternative Relational Query Plans for Database

Education

PROCEEDINGS OF THE ACM ON MANAGEMENT OF DATA (PACMMOD / SIGMOD 2026)

2026

- Hui Li, Hu Wang, Sourav S. Bhowmick, and **Zihao Ma**. DOI: 10.1145/3802122 Code

Research Experience

TIPS, Xidian University

Xi'an, China

RESEARCH PROJECT

2024 – 2026

- Extended experiments in response to reviewer feedback, including completing embedding-based baselines and expanding benchmark evaluation.

Skills

Programming

C/C++, Rust, Python, SQL

Database Systems

Query Optimization, Query Execution, PostgreSQL

Tools

Git, Linux, $\text{\LaTeX}$